Chapter 36

Paka suva – Fish poisoning leaves

Helen Kobaa Magum, Shalom Magum, & Joyce Maion



Figure 1: *Paka suva* – Fish poisoning leaves

(1)	*Enaa kahi vahutate ni nom havee to suvasuva vaavaha mi raara a paka suva, eara a ta Teapu.*	I am going to describe how we poison fish with *suva* leaves, we the Teop people.
(2)	*Beara mei rara tea nao tea suva-suva tea masi,*	Before we go to poison fish on the reef at low tide,

Shalom Magum Helen Kobaa Magum & Joyce Maion. 2026. *Paka suva* – fish poisoning leaves. In Ulrike Mosel (ed.), *The material culture of the Teop people of Bougainville*, 225–226. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22880300

(3)	*eara toro matatopo roho amaa taba to pasi dee raara tea suvasuva.*	we must prepare the things that we take with us to poison fish.
(4)	*Momohu eara toro nao rasuu tea osi paka suva teo hum to neba komana raara eve.*	First we must go to the jungle to pick the *suva* leaves at the place where we plant them.
(5)	*Beara osi, eara toro osi vaberobero, eara repaa dee voosu eve.*	When we pick the leaves, we must pick plenty and carry them home.
(6)	*Beara tau nao, eara repaa vaobete a paka suva teo hoi.*	Before we go, we put the *suva* leaves into a basket.
(7)	*Eara repaa kae vo tea masi.*	Then we carry it to the reef.
(8)	*Beara no suguna tea kopua, eara repaa tara voen, o iana na tei rori teebona,*	When we arrive at a pool and see that there are the fish,
(9)	*eara repaa vahio o hoi paka suva.*	we put the basket with the *suva* leaves down.
(10)	*Eara repaa taneo tea buhaha a paka suva.*	Then we start rubbing the *suva* leaves into pulp with our hands.
(11)	*Buhaha bata mi raara bono kasuana to karusu bata raara komana kopua.*	We rub them with sand that we collect with our hands in the pool.
(12)	*Eara buhaha batara, beara peo binubinu bata ni rae komana kopua, ge tea maa avaava teo vasu.*	We rub them into pulp, while scattering them everywhere in the pool or in the caves of the stones.
(13)	*Beara suva batara, eara repaa tara voen o iana na mate batari, eara repaa antee tea buhaha a paka suva.*	When we do the poisoning, and we see that the fish are dying, we stop rubbing the *suva* leaves into pulp.
(14)	*Eara repaa taneo tea mosi o iana to bubuutoo bata maana.*	Then we start killing the struggling fish with a knife.
(15)	*A paka suva vai to paa buhaha vuru ara, na kaokahi koa raara komana kopua,*	The *suva* leaves that we have rubbed into pulp we leave in the pool,
(16)	*ei kou paa kavara vaevuru a kikis nae.*	because their strength has already gone.
(17)	*Eara repaa kae voosu o hoi iana.*	Then we carry the basket full of fish home.
(18)	*Eve koai o sii vahuatate kakato vaa tea suvasuva nia paka suva.*	This is the short description of poisoning fish with *suva* leaves.